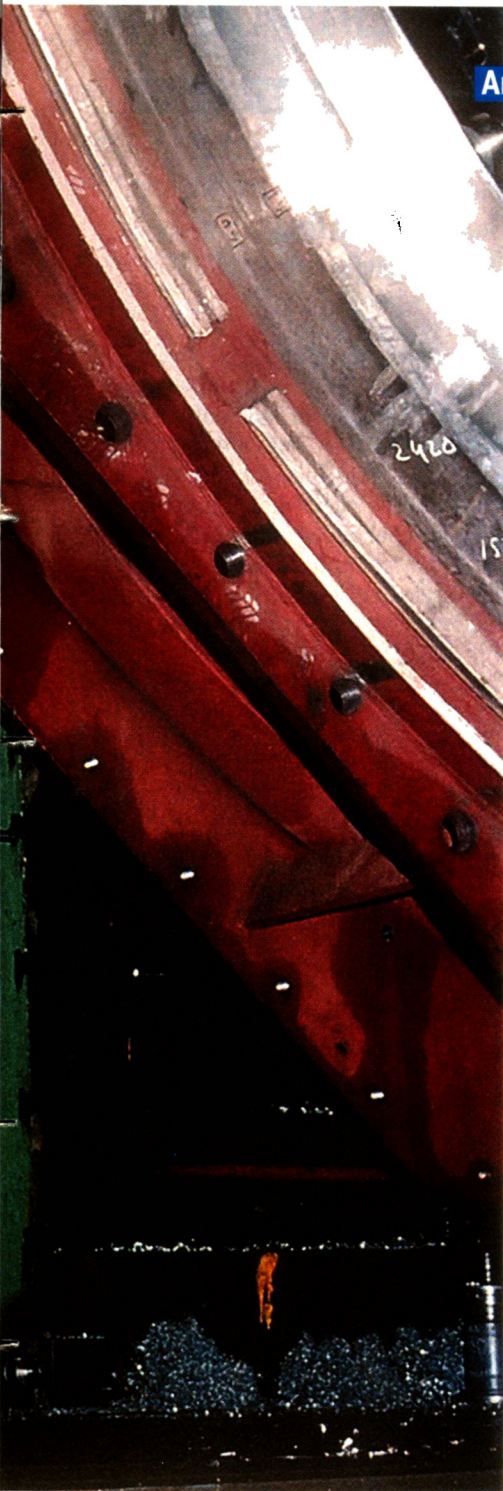




Anil Manibhai Naik 67, CEO

"Smaller, simpler projects will be scrapped over the time. What is our core now will no longer be our core. We also want diversity of geography."

Naik has been the key to unlocking this power. He was also the driving force behind the creation of heavy engineering facilities at the flagship Hazira plant in Gujarat in the 1980s, which has enhanced the ability of the firm to design, engineer and manufacture reactors, pressure vessels, columns and towers. Setting his sights higher each time, Naik expanded the firm's footprint abroad, particularly in the Gulf. In 2008, it bagged the largest ever order placed with a single manufacturer in the world to build 22 critical reactors for Kuwait National Petroleum Company for Rs 1,695 crore. And with Naik set to resign in 2012, the future of the company is being chalked out and a new breed of leaders being nurtured. Having diversified over the decades, L&T will now focus on the booming sectors of power, oil, nuclear energy and railways, airports and roads.

"Smaller, simpler projects will be scrapped and over time, what is now our core will no longer be our core. We also want diversity of geography. We'll be firing from many cylinders," says Naik. In 2008 the firm clinched a Rs 1,047-crore order from the Indian Railways to set up a cast steel manufacturing plant at Saran, Bihar. In the first turnkey project of its kind in India without international collaboration, the plant will meet the huge shortage of wheels for rolling stocks. It also ex-

pects to contribute Rs 7,000 to Rs 8,000 crore to the nuclear energy business in the next five years from its Hazira plant, which is capable of manufacturing nuclear reactors that can produce 4,000 to 6,000 MW of power every year. "Over the last 10 years, we have graduated in complex projects. In 1999, I decided I did not want to do any project less than Rs 10 crore. Then it moved to Rs 50 crore and now it's no less than Rs 100 crore for a building," says Naik.

Some of the biggest challenges of the company have been finding and retaining engineering talent and sustaining the growth momentum while the economy has suffered a blow. While this is a pro-infrastructure Government, Naik says India has a long way to go to meet its infrastructure shortage. According to him, India needs to spend

\$150 billion per year like China, explaining that infrastructure is the key to development of the industry, services and farming sector. "The Government's ability to spend keeps being hit. Money gets diverted to things like drought and farmers. We need to bring in international funds, private equity investment and open the economy further," he says.

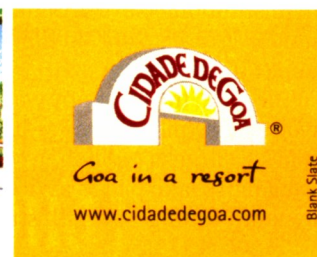
L&T's journey so far has been that of a nation builder and Naik is ensuring it will remain so long after he has left the firm. First Country, then company and last you. Naik has lived up to the company's motto.

by Nishika Patel

1,52,150 MW
is the total
installed capacity
of electricity
production in
India, making it
the fifth largest
producer in
the world.



leisure
all-year
adventure
pleasure



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